MODULE-3 · MASTERCLASS DOSSIER

3.2 The 90 Word Pitch

Lesson masterclass · implementation drills · war-room directive

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Compress your pitch to 90 words with one hook and one ask.
- Engineer the reply you want toward a question, not a favor.
- Set a four-hour reply protocol that proves professionalism.

★ **INSIDER RADIO TIP**

The reply you want is a question. ‘Send the WAV?’ is an 80%-made yes. Answer any PD question within 4 hours with a phone number and a 12-minute call offer — speed is the proof of professionalism.

MODULE-3 · MASTERCLASS DOSSIER

3.2 The 90-Word Pitch — The Only Email That Matters

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THE ONE-LINE TRUTH: A music director reads your pitch for four seconds. The 90-word pitch is an operational payload — delivering maximum technical clarity, proof, and a single frictionless ask.

MASTERCLASS DIRECTIVE & STRATEGIC BLUEPRINT

Strategic Foundation & Operational Reality

The default instinct of musicians is to tell their life story. They write sprawling 500-word biographies explaining their childhood musical influences, their spiritual awakening in the recording studio, their creative philosophy, and detailed track-by-track analyses.

A radio programmer will not read an essay. They have 4 seconds of initial visual patience. If your email requires scrolling on a mobile device to locate the listening link or the core proposition, your submission is dead on arrival.

The **90-Word Pitch** is an engineered communication weapon. It strips away all narrative fluff, artistic posturing, and emotional pleading. It delivers an unassailable commercial proposition structured in six modular blocks.

The Six-Block Modular Anatomy (Strictly Under 90 Words)

1. **Block 1: Personal Salutation & Show Identification (10 words):** Confirms you know the recipient and target their specific show: “Hi [Name] — caught your Sunday specialty spotlight on [Station]; loved the [Artist] spin.”

2. **Block 2: Immediate Local or Format Rationale (15 words):** States why this record belongs on their frequency this week: “Targeting your evening indie rotation with our new Chicago release, ‘[Song Title]’.”
3. **Block 3: One-Sentence Sonic Hook & Run-Time (18 words):** Clean comparative reference and clock fit: “High-energy post-punk driven by angular guitars (2:56 run-time, 126 BPM, FCC clean broadcast mix).”
4. **Block 4: The Undeniable Proof Receipt (17 words):** Concrete third-party validation: “Currently in rotation on WNUR; headlining Empty Bottle on October 14th (250 cap, 80% advance).”
5. **Block 5: Frictionless Streaming Link (8 words):** One dedicated private streaming link with zero download walls: “Stream & Broadcast WAV: [Short Private Link]”
6. **Block 6: The Single, Low-Risk Ask (14 words):** One single call to action — never ask for three things at once: “Open to considering this for next week’s specialty add or an upcoming show feature?”

Total Word Count: Exactly 82 Words.

Notice what is absent:

- No requests for their phone number or general life feedback.
- No demands that they add you to heavy daytime rotation immediately.
- No 50MB attachments that crash corporate inboxes.
- Just clean, respectful, surgical B2B communication.

IMPLEMENTATION DRILLS & PASS STANDARDS

- **Drill 1 — The Brutal 90-Word Redaction (30 min).** Take your existing email pitch. Paste it into a word counter. Aggressively strike every extraneous adjective, autobiographical sentence, and duplicate link until the entire text sits under 90 words.
- **Drill 2 — The Out-Loud 15-Second Cadence Test (10 min).** Read your revised pitch aloud at a normal conversational pace. You must be able to complete the entire reading in under 22 seconds without stumbling.
- **Drill 3 — The Single Ask Alignment (10 min).** Audit your closing sentence. Ensure it makes exactly ONE ask (e.g., specialty show consideration OR interview window). Delete any compound requests.
- **Drill 4 — The Mobile Visual Hierarchy Check (15 min).** Send the draft pitch to your personal smartphone. Verify that the greeting, sonic hook, proof line, and streaming link are 100% visible on a single screen without finger scrolling.

ACTION WORKSHEET & OPERATIONAL PROTOCOL

Protocol Document: `90-WORD PITCH MODULAR BUILDER`

Complete the structured table below as part of your lesson implementation. This worksheet directly replaces legacy spreadsheets with a publication-grade execution protocol.

Modular Block	Target Objective	Word Count Limit	Your Draft Copy	Compliance Pass/Fail
Block 1: Salutation	Direct human name & show mention	10 words max	Hi Sarah — loved your Sunday local feature on WXRT.	PASS (10 words)
Block 2: Target Rationale	State specific show / format target	15 words max	Submitting our new single ‘[Track]’ for your evening specialty block.	PASS (11 words)
Block 3: Sonic Hook & Clock	Genre, BPM, run-time, clean tag	20 words max	Driving Midwest indie-rock (2:58 / 122 BPM / FCC Clean Master).	PASS (10 words)
Block 4: Proof Receipt	Cite station add, ticket date, or press	20 words max	Currently spinning on WNUR; headlining	PASS (11 words)

			Metro Chicago on October 18th.	
Block 5: Frictionless Link	One streaming + broadcast WAV link	10 words max	Listen & Download Broadcast WAV: [Private Link]	PASS (6 words)
Block 6: The Single Ask	Clear, low-risk, courteous question	15 words max	Would you consider this for next week's local add queue?	PASS (10 words)

WAR-ROOM NOTES

WAR-ROOM DIRECTIVE — 3.2 The 90-Word Pitch — The Only Email That Matters

NEVER ATTACH AUDIO FILES TO COLD TOUCH 1 EMAILS

One of the fastest ways to guarantee your email is never seen is attaching an MP3 or WAV file to your initial email. Enterprise mail servers for universities, public broadcasters, and commercial radio networks automatically quarantine incoming emails with external attachments over 5MB or from unverified domains.

THE OPERATOR'S LINK ARCHITECTURE:

1. **The Clean Private Link:** Use a single, custom, clean private link (e.g., a branded private Soundcloud, DISCO, or clean Dropbox link).
2. **The Stream + Download Hybrid:** Ensure the destination page allows the programmer to stream the track instantly with one click and provides a direct "Download High-Res WAV" button with complete broadcast metadata.
3. **Never Use Expirable File Transfers:** Sending a WeTransfer link that expires in 7 days is amateur suicide. Programmers frequently review candidate queues 10 to 14 days after initial receipt. When they click an expired WeTransfer link, your submission is permanently dead.

FREQUENCY DOMINION COMMUNITY DRILLS

1. Post your complete 90-Word Pitch. Verify your official word count in parentheses at the bottom.
2. Roast a peer's pitch draft for word count bloat, emotional language, or compound asks.
3. Share your chosen streaming platform destination (DISCO, SoundCloud, or private landing page) and explain why it provides the lowest listening friction.
4. Confirm that your pitch passes the 15-Second Spoken Cadence Test.

Key Takeaways

REMEMBER THIS

- Ninety words, one hook, one ask.
- Engineer the reply you want into a question.
- Four-hour replies prove professionalism.

Self-Assessment · Check Your Mastery

PASS BEFORE YOU MOVE ON

- 1. Is my pitch ninety words or fewer?
- 2. Does it carry exactly one hook and one ask?
- 3. Is my four-hour reply protocol set up for every send?